Vagan Manukian
Lead Product Designer

9+ years in product and digital design, visual communication, and front-end

💼 Employment History

Senior Product Designer / Design Lead at AliExpress

Sep 2023 – Sep 2025

Owned the design of the shopping cart and later led design across the broader Personal Zone — checkout, profile, and orders — on a platform with 35M+ MAU in Russia.

Full Cart redesign with onboarding, “Save for later”, “Buy Now” actions and coupon mechanics
Cart-to-checkout conversion +6.9%
Buyer conversion +1.7%
GMV from cart recommendations +49%

Profile: passport data collection (manual & automated) and unified communications across login, PDP, orders, checkout
Passport completeness 67% → 80%

Checkout: streamlined address handling and order creation
Checkout-to-order conversion +5.7%
Average items per order +4.9%

Beyond core scope
Product cards (platform-wide): initiated and contributed to redesign improving information hierarchy, price/promo clarity, and visual consistency across listings
Conversion 2.2% → 6.7%
Success rate 62% → 87%

Beyond core scope
Bundle-deals sales channel (internal “Combo/Choice”): designed a dedicated cart with mandatory threshold logic and a cross-page progress bar; co-created the channel’s visual identity (logo, “combo” metaphor, KO-style visuals); improved navigation and supported design across the full flow
Conversion 2.2% → 6.7%
Success rate 62% → 87%
Choice Order Adoption +2.2%
Payments +3.1%
UV value +2.9%

Founder / Product Designer at UniBag

Dec 2022 – June 2023

Developed a browser extension, with a mobile app concept, that allowed users to save products across stores, track prices and availability, apply promo codes, and complete checkout in one click.

Owned the product vision, UX/UI design, and early prototyping.

Senior communication designer at Yandex Fintech unit

Jan 2022 – Apr 2022

Designed scalable promo pages for launching and testing new fintech products for an audience of 100,000+ users. Developed visual identities for fintech products, delivered marketing content with external collaborators, and art-directed physical products for internal team use.

Interface and communication consultant at SmallTalk

Sep 2020 – May 2021

Developed the brand identity and a modular interface for an AI-powered spoken English learning platform.

Worked closely with English teachers to understand the learning process and design exercise formats that made the product both distinctive and useful.

Used AI-generated faces for exercise visuals to give each lesson a unique feel and make interactions feel more natural and conversational.

Freelance projects

Oct 2019 – Jan 2022

Worked independently across a range of e-commerce projects, contributing product design, UX/UI, and digital art direction.

Junior to Senior designer at WRS Design Studio

Aug 2017 – Oct 2019

Conceptualized, prototyped, and tested design solutions for web, mobile, and iOS products.

Presented concepts to clients and maintained clear communication throughout the project lifecycle.

Art-directed 3D artists and illustrators to support broader design needs.

Worked closely with engineers throughout development to ensure high-quality implementation and pixel-accurate delivery.

Product designer and digital art-director at Madfrenzy

2017 – 2021

Madfrenzy is a London-based fashion brand with an unconventional approach to everyday wear, and I worked with the team on a range of digital product and brand initiatives from 2017 to 2021.

As part of the team, I contributed to market analysis, user research, usability testing, content creation, UX writing, and special marketing web projects.

Key features included breadcrumb-inspired navigation, a photo-led product page with a split-screen view for both men and women, and an automated size recommendation system powered by an interactive WebGL gender-neutral model that changed proportions based on selected size.

I also designed collection sliders for faster product browsing and added small interaction details that supported the brand’s “From Office Chair To Mountain Air” concept.

🎓 Education

National University of Science and Technology
Applied Informatics Master’s Degree

SKILLS

Product Design
Design Leadership
Design Systems
Interaction Design
User Research
Product Analytics
Visual Communication
Content Design
Creative Direction
AI Tools & Workflows
Front-end Development
HTML / CSS / JavaScript
Figma

vaganmanukian.com

Available internationally